

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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SOME GOOD ADVICE FROM THE BOOK OF ECCLESIASTES CHAPTER 10.

Ecclesiastes 10:7

*7. I have seen servants upon horses, and Princes walking as servants
upon the Earth. KJV*

7 I have even seen servants riding, while princes walk like servants! TLB

It is always a sad thing to see those persons who have lesser skills and qualities in positions of authority while those who have the qualifications and proven record are demoted to a lower position.

1 Timothy 3:6 Not a novice, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil. KJV

1 Timothy 3:6 An elder must not be a new believer, because he might become proud, and the devil would cause him to fall. NLT

This is good advice when seeking to choose anyone into a position of leadership or authority in God's work. Appointing or ordaining persons who are not qualified, skills-wise, character-wise and emotionally unsuited into positions of authority will result in disappointment and the possibility of damage done to other people's lives.

Beware of nepotism, which is the practice of showing favouritism to family members or friends, especially by giving them jobs, promotions, or other privileges based on personal relationships rather than their skills or qualifications.

*In the mid-17th century: from French **népotisme**, from Italian **nepotismo**, from **nipote** 'nephew' (with reference to privileges bestowed on the 'nephews,' etc.*

JESUS ALSO SHOWED THIS PRINCIPLE OF CHOOSING NOT TO COMMIT HIMSELF TO ALL PEOPLE BECAUSE OF SOME APPARENT LACK OF CHARACTER QUALITIES OR COMMITMENT TO HIMSELF AND HIS MISSION.

JESUS RECOGNIZED THE LIMITATIONS OF A MAJORITY OF THEM AND SOME HE DID NOT TRUST.

HOWEVER, THERE WERE SOME PERSONS THAT HE DID HAVE CONFIDENCE IN AND ENTRUSTED HIMSELF TO THEM – AS THEY WERE TO BE THE FUTURE CUSTODIANS TO CARRY OUT THE FATHER'S WILL AFTER JESUS DEPARTED THIS EARTH.

FOR US TO OBSERVE THIS, WE NEED TO LOOK AT THE PEOPLE THAT SURROUNDED HIS LIFE AND MINISTRY AND HIS INTERACTION WITH THEM.

FIRSTLY, THERE WERE:

1. THE MULTITUDES THAT FOLLOWED

Matthew 8:1 When he was come down from the mountain, great multitudes followed him. KJV

Matthew 15:30 And great multitudes came unto him. KJV

Matthew 19:2 And great multitudes followed him; and he healed them there. KJV

2. THEN THE GENERAL BELIEVERS - who believed in his name

John 2:23 Now when he was in Jerusalem at the passover, in the feast day, many believed in his name, when they saw the miracles which he did. KJV

John 7:31 And many of the people believed on him, and said, When Christ cometh, will he do more miracles than these which this man hath done? KJV

Many believed in him but for fear of the Jews and the religious leaders, they did not follow Jesus, and they failed to speak openly of him as the Messiah (John 12:42 NIV).

3. AND THE TRUE DISCIPLES only if they continued to follow his teachings – his words

John 8:31 Then said Jesus to those Jews which believed on him, If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed; KJV

4. THEN THERE WERE THE WORKERS - the 70

Luke 10:1-2

1 The Lord now chose seventy other disciples and sent them on ahead in pairs to all the towns and villages he planned to visit later.

2 These were his instructions to them: "Plead with the Lord of the harvest to send out more laborers to help you, for the harvest is so plentiful and the workers so few. TLB

5. THE 12 APOSTLES

Luke 6:13-16 (NIV) When morning came, he called his disciples to him and chose twelve of them, whom he also designated apostles: 14 Simon (whom he named Peter), his brother Andrew, James, John, Philip, Bartholomew, 15 Matthew, Thomas, James son of Alphaeus, Simon who was called the Zealot, 16 Judas son of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor.

6. THEN THERE WAS PETER, JAMES & JOHN

Notice the close relationship that Jesus had with the three men.

Jesus invited and included them and showed a willingness to have them accompany him in his ministry engagements which expressed special measure of trust in them.

Example - Read

Matthew 17:1 - Mark 1:29-32 - Mark 5:37 - Luke 8:51- Mark 13:3-5 – Mark 14:33-34 - Luke 5:10 - John 13:23 NIV

7. THEN THERE ARE THE MANY WHO BELIEVED WHEN THEY SAW THE MIRACLES

*** HOWEVER, JESUS DID NOT COMMIT OR ENTRUST HIMSELF TO THEM.**

John 2:23-24 Now when he was in Jerusalem at the Passover, in the feast day, many believed in his name, when they saw the miracles which he did.

24 But Jesus did not commit himself unto them, because he knew all men KJV

John 2:24 But Jesus would not entrust himself to them, for he knew all men. NIV

*** JESUS DID NOT COMMIT HIMSELF TO THESE PEOPLE.**

*** HE DID NOT TRUST HIMSELF TO THE PEOPLE.**

*** HE DID NOT COMMIT HIMSELF TO THEM BECAUSE THEY HAD COME FOR THE MIRACLES AND NOT NECESSARILY FOR JESUS'S TEACHING OR THE PURPOSE THAT HE CAME INTO THE WORLD.**

*** BUT HE DID TRUST THOSE WHO WERE COMMITTED TO FOLLOWING HIS TEACHING (John 8:31) AND TO HIS 12 APOSTLES AND ESPECIALLY PETER, JAMES AND JOHN WHO WERE THE CLOSEST TO HIM.**

*** FROM CHRIST'S EXAMPLE WE CAN LEARN THAT IT IS CRUCIAL WHEN SELECTING PERSONNEL FOR LEADERSHIP AND OVERSEEING CRITICAL MATTERS RELATING TO THE SPIRITUAL HEALTH OF THE LOCAL CHURCH THAT THEY SHOULD BE:**

*** THOSE WHO ARE THE CLOSEST TO THE LORD.**

*** THOSE WHOSE HEARTS ARE SOFTEST TOWARDS THE LORD JESUS!**

*** THOSE WHO WILL PASSIONATELY CARRY ON THE MISSION OF CHRIST AND THE STATED VISION AND MINISTRY OF THE LOCAL CHURCH.**

Amen - Ps Barry